

P.A.I.N. / Quick reference

ARTIST TEAM | ADULT EDITION | ENGLISH | 9 SEPTEMBER 2026

The project

Personal And Interconnected with Nature. The Personal-Planetary-Pain Map brings bodily pain, emotional language, environmental pressure, and economic circumstances into a shared artwork.

Its layers offer different kinds of evidence and different ways to think about care. They do not form one universal score of suffering.

The four layers

PHYSICAL: estimated burden of six painful conditions, given a scarred and dotted surface. Sources: IHME Global Burden of Disease and WorldPop population information. 15,282 mapped observations. Concentrated populations can contribute to concentrated burden.

EMOTIONAL: forms of distress recognized in selected texts and displayed as words across languages. A prominent category is not a national identity or a diagnosis.

ENVIRONMENTAL: warming and emission-related pressure represented as an atmosphere. Sources: Berkeley Earth and Climate TRACE. 8,100 temperature and 2,339 emissions observations. A cold place can warm strongly; atmospheric appearance is not measured smoke or exposure.

SOCIOECONOMIC: stronger yellow where GDP per person is lower. Source: World Bank, 2024. 190 available values. Economic output is not a typical salary or a complete picture of well-being.

Current exhibition

The projection still uses an earlier emotional selection of 249,438 texts. Its words and the latest research results are different views, explained separately in the project guide.

Delaunay connections organize countries sharing a category. Gabriel is a sparser alternative. The lines express geographic structure and shared themes, not pain spreading between populations.

Latest PCAI research

- Completed combined analysis: 26,176,468 texts across 192 countries.
- 25,932,030 news articles plus 244,438 posts and complaints.
- Adopted classifier fitted on 333,236 synthetic examples.
- Prepared teaching collection: 573,143 examples across 100 languages.
- Latest news: 104 language/variety hints; mostly recorded as 2017-2024.
- News provides about 99.07% of records in the latest equal-record combination.
- Anger/moral injury leads in 178 of 192 combined results; this describes model readings of texts.

The detailed chapter explains the model, source mixture, evaluation, and limits. These counts are not counts of people interviewed or measures of national emotional prevalence.

Country examples

- **INDIA:** population concentration and the burden of recurring pain.
- **JAPAN:** back pain, mobility, ageing, and independence.
- **RUSSIA / CANADA:** cold places and strong warming signals.
- **BURUNDI / LUXEMBOURG:** economic resources and the limits of national averages.
- **PALAU:** one visible word cannot speak for a whole population.
- **COMOROS:** visibility differs between source collections.

Optional framing

- **Everyday:** "What changes in a person's day when movement becomes difficult?"
- **Artistic:** "The globe makes what the world carries visible."
- **Scientific:** "Each layer is a different kind of evidence about a place."
- **For a young child:** "This globe helps us think about looking after people and places."

These are starting points to adapt, combine, or ignore. There is no required wording or sequence.

Shared background for explaining the project in your own words. Examples are possibilities, not required wording.